

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

31 August 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

The Legal Assistant roles at CarterBells Solicitors appeal to me because they sit within a Private Client and Commercial Property practice, and my background in real estate disputes and client-facing advisory work maps directly onto both departments.

During my year at BCLP, six months of which were spent in Real Estate Disputes, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, reviewed documents across several concurrent matters, assisted with court filings and maintained matter records using iManage. Deadlines competed constantly, and managing that required keeping files organised and flagging outstanding actions early. That experience gave me a working understanding of property-related disputes, including leasehold issues and landlord and tenant matters, which overlaps with the kind of documentation and casework a Commercial Property team handles day to day.

My client communication experience at Citizens Advice has developed the other side of this role. I take detailed client statements, manage correspondence, draft applications and maintain confidential case records across welfare, housing and debt matters. Many of my clients are in difficult circumstances, so communicating clearly and reliably is not optional. I have also become comfortable translating procedural requirements into plain language, which is a practical skill in any client-facing legal department.

I am currently working as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire alongside my LLM at Queen Mary, so I am used to managing documents, correspondence and deadlines simultaneously under time pressure. I am proficient in Word and Outlook, and I am comfortable with digital file management and case management systems from my time at BCLP.

Kingston upon Thames is a straightforward commute for me, and the chance to work across two active departments in a firm with genuine client work at this stage of my training is the kind of practical step I am looking for.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva